

StoryCast - Research & Planning Document

1. Project Overview

StoryCast is a 3-page accessible media microsite showcasing audio and video storytelling from African creatives and the diaspora. The platform prioritizes accessibility, semantic structure, and responsive design. Built with vanilla HTML5, Sass, and no frameworks.

2. Information Architecture

The site has three pages: Home (index.html), Story Detail (story/episode-one.html), and About (about.html). The Home page is the entry point, linking to both the Story Detail and About pages via the main navigation.

3. Design Decisions

- Dark theme (#0D0D0D) chosen to reduce eye strain during long listening sessions
- Gold accent (#E8C547) represents warmth of voice and audio storytelling
- Playfair Display for editorial headings, Inter for body text, JetBrains Mono for transcripts
- Container queries on the featured card allow layout to respond to component size not viewport

4. Accessibility Approach

- All pages meet WCAG 2.1 AA standard
- Gold on black contrast ratio: 10.6:1 (minimum required: 4.5:1)
- Skip links on every page for keyboard users
- ARIA labels and aria-labelledby on all sections and navigation
- Focus states via :focus-visible on all interactive elements
- Audio includes figcaption and full inline transcript with timestamps
- Video includes WebVTT captions via track element set as default
- prefers-reduced-motion respected across all pages

5. Responsive Strategy

- CSS Grid for story grid: 3 columns → 2 columns → 1 column
- Flexbox for navigation, footer, and card internals
- Container query on featured card switches to horizontal layout at 500px
- clamp() used for fluid typography on all major headings

